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Product Management Leader at UnitedHealth Group Sees Pace as a Strategic Asset for P&C Insurance Workflow Automation

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
13 Aug 2026	11 Aug 2026	Customer	AI Interviewer	PACE (WITHPACE)

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covers the evaluation, implementation, and operational impact of Pace, an automation platform for P&C insurance workflows, within a large healthcare organization. Discussion includes team usage, ROI, competitive landscape, integration challenges, and future adoption outlook.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Product management leader at a large healthcare organization, responsible for AI strategy and product integration across multiple healthcare and insurance domains, including property & casualty (P&C) and workers' compensation claims.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- Views Pace as a critical and increasingly strategic part of operations, moving from pilot to core workflow integration.
- Believes **Pace delivers strong ROI through automation**, accuracy, and scalability, but notes some gaps in document handling and integration remain.
- Is **optimistic about continued improvements and expansion with Pace**, but would consider switching if a competitor offered superior accuracy, integration, and workflow support.

TAKEAWAYS

- Pace is used by three main teams (workers' compensation network management, intelligent intake, and policy servicing/maintenance), with over 50 users in the P&C module.
- Pace replaced both an internal document management tool and significant manual processes, enabling the organization to bring previously outsourced P&C claims work in-house.
- Implementation took 6-10 weeks per workflow, was handled internally with direct support from Pace, and required translating SOPs into agentic operating procedures and API integrations.
- **Key benefits realized include dramatic reductions in document processing time** (from a month to three days), 10X claims processing speed, improved accuracy, and operational cost savings.
- **Pace was chosen over competitors (Hyperscience, Cytora, Gradient AI) for its system-agnostic integrations, human-in-the-loop capabilities, and compliance with healthcare data privacy needs, but still faces challenges with handwritten annotation**, ACORD form segmentation, and legacy system integration.

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Table of Contents

Introduction and Organizational Overview

Pace Usage and Team Involvement

Operational Impact and Pain Points

Implementation and ROI Analysis

Market Landscape and Competitive Evaluation

Decision Factors and Integration Process

Implementation Timeline and Service Quality

Renewal Considerations and Switching Costs

Pricing and Satisfaction Metrics

Future Outlook and Final Thoughts

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Expert Bio

Product Management at UnitedHealth Group Customer of Pace, led the setup of the test and pilot environments, including preparing the evaluation datasets. Also delivered demonstrations to the program sponsors, enabling them to assess the solution and make an informed decision Product Management at UnitedHealth Group. Reporting to the Senior Vice President of Product, the expert is responsible for leading the strategic roadmap and lifecycle management of healthcare technology solutions. Within this role, they maintain full Profit and Loss (P&L) responsibility for their product vertical, overseeing a multimillion-dollar budget and directing cross-functional teams to enhance provider-facing platforms and digital health integration. Prior to UnitedHealth Group, the expert was the Product Manager at athenahealth, leaving in April 2021. Reporting to the Director of Product Management, the expert was responsible for driving the development of electronic health record (EHR) features and revenue cycle management tools. They focused on optimising user experience for clinicians and streamlining data interoperability across large-scale medical networks. The expert can speak to the digital transformation of healthcare systems, the integration of AI in clinical workflows, and the nuances of managing high-growth health-tech portfolios. Additionally, they are a customer of and have implemented various enterprise software solutions, including Salesforce Health Cloud, Jira Align, ServiceNow, and Tableau for advanced data analytics. He has experience across various industries including Healthcare and Life Sciences, Financial Technology, and Consumer Goods and Retail.

Interview Transcript

AI Interviewer 00:00:00

Thank you for speaking with us about Pace, specifically around how you use it, the value it brings to your work, and how you see it positioned in the market. It should be a pretty natural conversation, so just share whatever comes to mind. To kick things off, can you tell me a bit about your organization and what it does?

Expert 00:00:18

Yes. Primarily, we are a healthcare organization where we take care of the multiple domains of the member health, may it be the corporate health plan, commercial health plan, Medicare, Medicaid, and ACA, and as well as we have the clinical facilities within our organization. We have large facilities, large clinics, wherein we take care of the member. As a part of the facility management, we as well take care of their property and casualty claims wherein the workers' compensation as a part of the benefit and loss for the member health. We as well take care of that. I'm associated with the chief AI office, wherein we primarily take care of taking the initiation and integration of the newer workflows into our ecosystem. That's where I sit in.

AI Interviewer 00:01:08

Thank you. It sounds like you are sitting at the intersection of AI strategy and product integration across a pretty broad set of healthcare domains. Within that role, are you primarily a hands-on user of Pace or more of a decision-maker and stakeholder when it comes to the product?

Expert 00:01:27

Yes. As a part of the intersection of the organization, we definitely have conducted the pilot program. Prior to that, we were always having our in-house capabilities of taking care of the P&C-related claims where any of the unforeseen incidents, may it be the fire or flood or the property and casualty-related workers' compensations arises. At a time as an organization, we started looking because since we are, as in the beginning mentioned, a healthcare organization. We started evaluating the products outside of our domain.

At that point in time, we definitely have participated in the demo and presenting our use cases and data to the Pace and similar products. As a part of onboarding the Pace product with us, within my team, we also are a part of their agentic operating models and agentic operating procedures. We also use that as a product. We evaluated it and we brought that product as a part of our integration, and then we primarily is the user of the product.

AI Interviewer 00:02:33

That's great context. It sounds like you were involved in both the evaluation and the implementation, and **your team is now actively** using the product. Can you tell me a bit more about which specific modules or products from Pace you're currently using?

Expert 00:02:48

Right. Since as a part of the P&C, as in workers' compensation, most of the time, if the claim has to be originated beyond healthcare. We have to do the use cases, including the submission intake, policy servicing, claims related to FNOL, first notification of the loss, and then the prior authorization services, the documentation, the policies documentation of our P&C health plans. Most of these health claims-related information to wherein the FNOL and the prior authorization-related services. We are primarily using the Pace for where the policy management, the policy servicing, FNOL notification, claims submission intake are primarily the domains where we have been using the Pace.

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AI Interviewer 00:03:34

Thank you. It sounds like you're using Pace primarily across policy management, policy servicing, FNOL, and claims submission intake within your workers' compensation and P&C workflows. Which teams within your organization are actually using the product day to day?

Expert 00:03:52

Yes. As a part of our teams, we have the back office operational team. The first team is our standard back office operations team. That is we called it as the workers' compensation network management team. What primarily that team is doing is, as and when **we get any claim or any information of notification of that so-and-so facility, so-and-so injury, or so-and-so accident** has happened at a certain place, it needs to be segregated into two components. One, healthcare, the other is the P&C claim.

We sit at the front end of that application where any kind of the claim intake, any kind of the FNOL notifications need to be generated, and then it needs to be associated to whether we have the policy of taking care of such losses, what kind of ACORD form we need to generate, what kind of document intelligence we need to associate, and then which kind of channel communication we need to maintain. Those are the teams as a part of the back office team, which take care of our network of the P&C module. It is primarily the users of this product.

AI Interviewer 00:05:00

Got it. The workers' compensation network management team is the primary user group on the back office side. Are there any other teams beyond that group who are also using Pace?

Expert 00:05:12

Yes. We also have two other teams, primarily, which is our network intelligence team, which is the intelligent intake team, which takes care of the ACORD format and the ACORD structure is the appropriate look. Intelligent intake team and the policy servicing and the maintenance team, which is primarily the high volume of the data coming in as a part of the policies and the compliance governance modules, which is coming in, wherein we need to maintain that high volume of back-end requests, including the beneficiary changes, address update. Policy service maintenance team and our intelligent intake team as a part of the application, which strictly manages the underwriting guidelines and data points where we have what is missing, what is incorrect. That is the intelligent intake team as well as the policy servicing and the maintenance team as well uses this product.

AI Interviewer 00:06:03

Great. You've got three teams in total, the workers' compensation network management team, the intelligent intake team, and the policy servicing and maintenance team. Roughly how many people across those three teams are using Pace, and what percentage of each team would you say that represents?

Expert 00:06:21

Yes. In total of our P&C module, we have close to 100+ team members who work into different operational workflows and groups. As a part of that 100+ organization team, we definitely have 50+ team members participating in using this product specifically, which is the intelligent intake team, policy services management team, and the operational team. It is 50+ member teams who use this product.

AI Interviewer 00:06:49

Roughly half of your P&C module team is actively using Pace. That's a pretty significant footprint. How long has your organization been working with Pace at this point?

Expert 00:07:01

Yes. We started evaluating the Pace as a product way back as a part of the evaluation process. We started working in July 2025, wherein starting July 2025, we were participating in the POC and the validation as a proof of concept and test validations we did. Post-July 2025, it has been like we have been actively working on this product. It has been more than a year, I can say, we have been using this product.

AI Interviewer 00:07:31

What are the main pain points that Pace is solving for your organization?

Expert 00:07:36

Yes, definitely. As I mentioned, the first and foremost thing is, since we are the healthcare organization and we definitely have to take care and we are definitely adaptive to the healthcare ecosystem. As a part of the recent acts which says that as a part of the healthcare

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organization, if we are going beyond the healthcare as a facility management and wherein our property and casualty-related claims also arises as a part of the workers' compensation. We are not expert in the P&C claim management, the back-office management of that, ACORD notifications, the different templates which are being required in the ACORD. I can definitely say that managing our P&C claim life cycle, like how does the claims need to be enrolled? How does the claim intake to the policy management need to happen?

How does the different templates, whether it's the fire or it's the natural calamity we need to map it to? We definitely are not expert in that. It is helping us to manage primarily three things. One is the exhaustive intake policy servicing and policy documentation. It is helping us to maintain. The second part is it is also allowing us to maintain the prior authorization, large volume of the prior authorization it is maintaining, and then definitely the document-heavy workflows where we need to extract the structured information from our carrier side, our payer side, which right now is being handled through our back office. That's where it is helping us a lot.

AI Interviewer 00:09:12

That's really helpful. It sounds like **Pace is essentially filling a domain expertise gap for you, helping a healthcare organization navigate the complexities of P&C** claim management that you wouldn't otherwise have in-house. You mentioned the document-heavy workflows and extracting structured information. Can you expand on how significant that pain point was before Pace came in?

Expert 00:09:36

Yes. Definitely, as a part of the documentation part is, so previously we used to have the three areas where carriers need to be sharing the policies, primarily insurers, and the brokers, and TPAs who used to manage those documentation. Those were significantly thousands of unstructured documents, the customer emails, the documents which was there. Definitely, going through that document, and as you have rightly understood, we are not there. Me extracting the meaningful information for that, how does this information need to be sent? How does this information need to be wired?

I can say that the huge amount of efforts, close to 100+ team members spending close to hundreds of hours per month, it has been through the Pace AI agent, which can understand the request, checks the rules, checks the data, which insurance systems it is operating, completes the transaction. It has been reduced to, I can say, close to couple of days, 72 hours or three days. I can say one month of effort has been definitely significantly reduced to the three days effort by automating this Pace AI agent-based data compliance component.

AI Interviewer 00:10:53

Wow, that's a pretty dramatic reduction from what sounds like a month's worth of effort down to roughly three days. That's a significant time saving. When you think about that in terms of business impact, what does that translate to for your organization? Is it location or something else?

Expert 00:11:11

Right. Definitely as an impact too. First thing is, as I mentioned, so **it has significantly helped us filling** in our ACORD forms, which is the standard commercial insurance application forms. The multiple, how does the liability section needs to be populated, our core important section, which is our property section, part of our facility, which is the construction, occupancy, fire protection, the other areas. It is able to be filled up.

Definitely the reduction in the time being spent, the accuracy it has brought into, and the scale. Now, we can definitely. We started with a pilot program of few facilities in a region, and now we are extending it, because we have close to 100,000 facilities across the states. We will be slowly expanding it to the scale. Scale, accuracy, and reduction in the manual efforts has been exponentially reduced. **That's the key benefits** we are getting.

AI Interviewer 00:12:13

Scale, accuracy, and manual effort reduction. That's a compelling combination, especially given the size of your facility footprint across the states. Do you view Pace as critical to your team's work at this point, or is it more of a nice-to-have?

Expert 00:12:29

No, definitely. As I mentioned, since we have been significantly working on expanding our agentic process outsourcing and reducing our back office or manual operations for the P&C, and specifically the workers' compensation factors too, where we need to expand these footprints. Definitely, we are looking for expanding it as a mandatorily in straight-through processing, where the metrics of the percentage coverages of the insurance cases being raised with Pace support, bringing in more accuracy. Traditionally, what we have seen is that our automation has always been need to be struggled with the large language models with where the document size, as I mentioned, is significantly high for how the facilities needs to be insured, how the workers' compensation needs to be addressed, how the documentation need to be sent to the claim.

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Definitely, the accuracy, straight-through process, and bringing in the operational efficiency gains by reducing the manual efforts, **which definitely will translate to operational cost reduction** annually by way of reducing the teams who need to spend those many hours. Definitely, I believe that going forward, we are going to expand this with Pace kind of the platform, where we will start onboarding more facilities as a P&C insurance business.

AI Interviewer 00:13:26

That's really clear. It sounds like **Pace is moving from a pilot into something much more strategically** embedded in your operations. I want to ask, how would your team manage this work if Pace weren't available to you?

Expert 00:13:40

Definitely. As a part of the without Pace environment, the three key areas. First part is that the policy management part is. As a part of that policy management and reading it through that, how does the compliance and policy management is happening for the P&C area, since we are not the experts. We have to heavily depend on the back office of the organizations, the TPAs and the MGAs thing. We primarily, I can say, have been traditionally working with all the major insurance carriers for State Farm and Allstate. We have TPAs like Broadspire, CorVel, and MGAs and wholesalers as well who were associated to taking care of specifically our P&C-related workers' compensations claim to where they used to fill up the employer policy information for us. We have outsourced this.

Said that, since as a compliance part of the restructuring of the insurance business in general happens too, so we as an organization need to focus on the healthcare-related aspects of the organization. Now this is our new team, new expansion of managing this work in-house. We have started using the agentic process outsourcing, which we called it as the AI agents, who is taking care of this work, which were previously being with our traditional insurance carriers, the exchange, through the exchange we were communicating on claim creation, claim processing, the TPA network, and the MGAs who used to help us previously. Now, we are trying to manage it in our own ecosystem.

AI Interviewer 00:15:20

That's really fascinating. Pace is in sense enabling you to bring in-house what was previously outsourced to TPAs and MGAs, which is a pretty significant strategic shift. Can you give me a broad sense of what you're spending with Pace annually?

Expert 00:15:38

Yes. As a part of the initial pilot, we started with somewhere $50,000-$100,000 spent. I believe after a year, this year, it will be close to, as of now, if I'm correct, it will be between $100,000-$250,000 annual spend.

AI Interviewer 00:15:57

Got it. You've roughly doubled your spend as you've expanded beyond the pilot. That makes sense given the growth trajectory you described. How do you think about the return on investment for that spend? Does it feel like good value for what you're getting?

Expert 00:16:16

Yes. Definitely, as I mentioned that previously, even for doing the policy review and the concept too. I'll break down into three primarily the areas. As in our submission intake and underwriting business, which is primarily submitting those P&C claim forms in compliance with the ACORD application, schedules of the values, the loss ratios, and the loss runs. **That has significantly improved from the accuracy part**. Previously, for example, our broker used to send us 30-page commercial property submissions document. We need to extract that, read that, and then interpret that. If that has, in a month, if we are spending, let's say, 1,000 hours. Now those have definitely been reduced to 72 hours. It has brought in significant readability and the extraction of the information to the locations, the values, and the property details too.

The second key area is our FNOL, which is the first notification of the loss. Previously, it used to be, we need to, as I mentioned, if it is one as a part of the document wherein the health-related claims and the accidental-related information. We need to read it through the FNOL, identify the loss, validate the policy coverage, all that as a captured information through that was all manual. It has also been automated. Last but not the least is about the claims QA. Previously, it used to be every second claim or the adjudication business need to be adjusted, worked upon for any errors, missing information too. Now, the speed has been 10X increase, every single day previously, if we were able to read 10 such claims by one member, now our agent can definitely read 100 such volumes too.

That is also **the efficiency has been increased too**. Definitely, in these areas, the time, **the efforts being spent manually has been significantly reduced,** and it is being taken care of our investments, which we have so far done with a limited workflow of the practices and the facilities which we have ensured as a part of the P&C claims.

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AI Interviewer 00:18:30

That's a really compelling ROI story. 10X the claims processing speed, **dramatically reduced document review time, and improved accuracy across submission**, intake, FNOL, and claims QA. Moving on to the competitive landscape, what other products did you evaluate before choosing Pace?

Expert 00:18:52

Yes. Definitely as a part of that, just to tell you that previously, since the P&C business was never our strength too. We have moved from Gradient and we have seen the Gradient and Strala and the products out there. We have compared it with the Hyperscience, Cytora, and the likes of this, and when we have done the pilot as well of these programs. We have seen that as a part of the competitive landscape, the structuring of the documentation when it comes to the third-party automation and the claims part, reading it through the end-to-end with our healthcare-related claims as a PII and the reasoning part of the clinics where we have started integrating with.

Definitely, as a part of the system-agnostic capabilities and security compliance, human-in-the-loop, and outcome-based ROI, while we were evaluating the Hyperscience, Cytora, and the Gradient AI, we definitely have zeroed in on to using in the workflow for the Pace.

AI Interviewer 00:19:52

That's helpful. You evaluated Hyperscience, Cytora, and Gradient AI before landing on Pace. What specifically made Pace stand out over those alternatives during the evaluation?

Expert 00:20:06

Our first and foremost need was that we definitely were looking for the aspect of automating our part for the documentation, the readability of our compliance part, associating those compliance part with our claims intake, segregating that to our core area of the insurance work of that, how does it will comply to the ACORD. How does the manual part of seamlessly jumping in between our internal systems to the external software, for example, the Guidewire and Duck Creek, the stricter healthcare conversations for where the data privacy is most important part.

The complex scenarios that, there are not always, for example, if **it is an accident within the facility**, we need to ensure that not only the facility-related claims are being generated, we also need to have the claims generated for is there any physical damage to any of our materials or the worker who was working, as a skilled nursing staff need to. There we definitely wanted human-in-the-loop. Based on that, **we definitely were expecting that outcome-based ROI wherein the casual document intake, lowering financial risk**, the transactional pricing of that, where our back-office work, which were previously taken care for the P&C billing operations need to be automated. There we found that, yes, as a part of the compliance part and our required parts in context to the medical insurance tech business, we have zeroed in on to the Pace as a product.

AI Interviewer 00:21:35

That's really clear. It was a combination of the system-agnostic integrations with tools like Guidewire and Duck Creek, the human-in-the-loop capability, the data privacy compliance, and the ability to handle complex multi-claim scenarios that really set Pace apart. Where do you think Pace falls short compared to those alternatives you evaluated?

Expert 00:21:57

Yes, definitely. As a part of that, as I mentioned, the first and foremost thing, we started with the compliance part of the readability of the compliance policies and the P&C policies too. Definitely, the first thing is the readability of the policies where asserting claims need to be segregated based on the workers' compensation versus a certificate of insurance needs to be issued. I can say the segregation of the ACORD forms between the ACORD four form to the ACORD 25 form versus ACORD 125 forms, and then the handwritten additions to the scribbling part, the frequency of the agents where they just scribble some adjuster notes, the policy exceptions, and the claimant details.

For example, if the coverage doesn't include any family member being added in last 30 days, and **that has been just scribbled by the agent on that policy**. The data silos, definitely the last but not the least. We need to separate it from the legacy health billing systems infrastructure to the native P&C ACORD form layout box, where human workers need to be intervened with it, as I mentioned, the segregation part of the platform.

These are primarily the three areas where primarily the ACORD-based segmentation, the hand-based or the agents-based scribbles of some of the nodes, what are the outliers of the policies, and then the data silos that, where do we need to call it out that this component will be the health-related component versus this will be the P&C-related policy tool. Those are some of the areas where Pace, I believe, falls short of the areas.

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AI Interviewer 00:23:35

That's really useful. The key gaps are around handwritten annotation recognition, ACORD form segmentation accuracy, and bridging the data silos between your legacy health billing systems and the native P&C infrastructure. Do you think those gaps are widening or narrowing over time? In other words, is Pace improving in those areas?

Expert 00:23:58

Definitely. First thing is that the automation part, I can say, as in last mile, which we call it as the last mile or the edge cases or the exceptions being written or unwritten rule, which is one of the hardest part to relate. Definitely, I can say that 80% of the processes to that, if the policy walkthrough need to happen, that the principle policy is A, it need to be navigated to B, to the C. That's how the rules need to be written, and that's how the automation can be addressed too. That is also narrowing it up.

The errors, which were previously the human errors, as I mentioned, that what needs to go in the health claim or health claim-related history versus where does the P&C claim life cycle, the document need to be started generating to, which is the AI errors, which are the most expensive errors. If we didn't have caught, **it would have eventually landed up into the wrong information and the bad outcome**. **Those as well has been significantly improving.**

Last but not the least, that definitely our regulatory-related issues, incorrect premium calculations, and then the claims which were previously not being able to be either raised or which previously rejected, which was the claims leakage. That is also, **I can see now is significantly improving**. It is working independently and exception handling, human reviews, and then that is how our AI models are learning and delivering to us.

AI Interviewer 00:25:28

It sounds like **the gaps are actually narrowing**. **The model is improving through exception handling and human review feedback loops, which is a good sign**. Is there anything a competitor could offer you today that would genuinely compel you to consider switching away from Pace?

Expert 00:25:45

As I mentioned, since there are the legacy systems, and then there are definitely the larger players out there. Even in the traditional insurance carriers, which are large, there are large TPAs. Many large TPAs and MGAs are operating out here. What I can say is that if the framework or fundamental, the modeling domain, LLMs can be trained around for the Guidewire-based, which is the standard, I can say the product operating out there. As a part of that, a separate rating engine which can be created that so and so policies need to be governed by such and such engine, which will rate these policies to be managed.

On top of that, our homegrown underwriting business, because as I mentioned, our healthcare-related facilities need a specific underwriting systems tool, like what calls to be workers' compensation, what calls the physical injury versus the damage to the property. We have our own underwriting systems tool, which we believe it quite complex and which can be closely integrated with the workload. If those kind of the areas like a Guidewire framework, which is having a separate rating engine, and then the underwriting specificities of the domain, which are applicable to automobile manufacturing and then healthcare. That can definitely help us to refine and to grow these platform to a next level, if I'm able to tell that.

AI Interviewer 00:27:14

That's really interesting. A deeper native integration with Guidewire, a more sophisticated rating engine, and domain-specific underwriting capabilities tailored to healthcare would be the kinds of things that could make you reconsider your options. Moving on to the market more broadly, how widespread do you think adoption of solutions like Pace is across the insurance and healthcare tech space right now?

Expert 00:27:38

Okay. One thing I can definitely say is that, since it was always a native business and a close to $500+ billion market as a part of the P&C business and the automation, definitely, if you go deeper into the business, how the policies and the guidelines, the submissions intakes, FNOL, the claims need to be automated and need to be managed autonomously. I believe right now, not even between 5%-7% market is being captured of the likes of platforms like Cytora, Withpace, Hyperscience, or Gradient, or platforms like these. Definitely, I believe, as a part of more adaptability coming into the business of P&C, if adaptability comes in, there is a huge market, I believe like 90% of the market is out there, which is available.

The players are also, there are, as I mentioned, Gradient AI, Tractable, Cytora, Hyperscience, Strala. There are many players, but still, the market navigations and the domain-specific, if it is able to manage the complete P&C journeys, if I can say. The end-to-end, right from the email coming in from the customers to the ACORD form generation, to the loss runs, to the exposure extraction, appetite check, enrichment, as I mentioned, the rating engines, the quotation which needs to be sent, and then the broader communication can be sent too, before we submit the final binding claim. If that end-to-end can be managed and is being adapted to, definitely, I believe that 90% of the market is out there of the close to $500 billion P&C market, which is out there, which needs automation is what I can say.

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AI Interviewer 00:29:24

That's a really striking picture. A $500 billion market with only 5%-7% penetration. **That's a massive untapped opportunity**. How long do you think it will take for meaningful adoption to happen across that remaining 90% of the market?

Expert 00:29:41

Okay. As I mentioned, there are the legacy applications who are massively managing as a part of the TPAs. There are larger skin in the game players who are TPAs, MGAs, and then Guidewire, Duck Creek, and Vertafore. Mostly the applications who manage end-to-end, majority of the part, they are somewhere broker applications, customer, employee-based application, policy administrations, claims management. They are doing that. Tapping **all of these opportunities through AI**, definitely the more accuracy, the more adaptability to the results and the outcomes. Most important part, human-in-the-loop flow where the agent should be able to call for a human support where it requires to.

The more transparency, the more accuracy, the more efficiency, if it brings to the forefront, the trust part and the empathetic part of these agentic-based workflows, adaptability will come. What I believe is that, next six months to 12 months to 18 months tenure will be an interesting tenure where an AI agent-based vendors, AI-based processing, outsourcing kind of the work could be potentially a makeshift kind of the opportunity for the organizations to start adapting to it.

AI Interviewer 00:30:56

You're thinking six to 18 months is the window where **we could see a real inflection point in adoption**, driven by trust, transparency, and accuracy improvements in agentic workflows. What's your view on how hard it would be for a start-up or a large existing player to come in and build a better version of what Pace does today?

Expert 00:31:17

Okay. As we know that bringing in another platform, through the way of using any of the platforms to be developed is not something which will require much efforts. Two, definitely the key areas, what kind of cases can be processed? What is the cost per case? How accurate that outcome of that AI models or the platform is? What is the exceptions? What is the SLA of the agents for the transformation tool?

Definitely, if we break down this into the what kind of the transactions, what kind of the documentations, the procedures, and the policies a platform can read too, where it can handle not only the medium to the complex underwriting rules for the smaller operations teams, it can handle the legacy workflows. If such complex areas and the stream of challenges is one by one picked up and is able to be solved by a platform is what will make a new entrant a difficulty or challenges to be met before a new product can be launched, is what I can say.

AI Interviewer 00:32:22

The barriers to entry are really around mastering the underwriting rules, legacy workflow integration, document handling at scale, and accuracy on edge cases. That's a meaningful moat for established players like Pace. Now, let me move on to the buying process. Were you involved in the decision to bring Pace on, and what role did you play in that?

Expert 00:32:45

Right. As a part of that, as I mentioned, we were always a part of the organization where we were internally managing such claims or such information. **The biggest opportunity** which was given to us is that we were given a task for that, we need to have a real platform where some of these back office-related P&C insurance processes, which are specifically extremely exception-heavy, can be handled through a product. We set up the data as a technical and the SME experts for the various products to be collaborated with. We conducted the pilot, and we have done the demo, as me and my team have done the demo to the leadership team, who were the decision-makers for which product to be selected.

We have shared the data for the enterprise, for the product, for the competitive analysis for our various products. We definitely then have gone ahead and shared that information as a demo part to our leadership team, who were the program sponsors, which allowed them to take the decision. We started from the pilot to the actual onboarding of some of these workflows, the facilitator-related workflows with the Pace.

AI Interviewer 00:33:54

Got it. You were the technical and SME lead driving the evaluation and pilot, while the final decision rested with the leadership and program sponsors. What were the key decision factors that your leadership weighed when they made the final call to go with Pace?

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Expert 00:34:11

The first and the foremost thing is that definitely they should be able to understand our workflow-based configurations, where they should be able to integrate, they should be able to switch it seamlessly between our legacy systems, they should be able to integrate with our internal systems, **who can read our claims engine, our demand letters, our cross-references of our EHRs and EMRs, and then can translate it to the ACORD forms, extract the data elements, and to the adjuster notes, the fault determinations,** and so on and so forth. The integration part, they should be able to communicate inside and outside of our system through an API architecturally. The scale and the workflow-based integration is one of the key areas where we were part of selecting the product and where we tested them.

The second important part is that FNOL notification and the intake part. Currently, those of the workflows were quite heavy manually. We need to manually abstract that information, create the form, do the submission intake, endorse the processing, generate the COI, and then do the claim QA. We wanted this part to be automated because we definitely believe that we are not the experts of these areas. We defined the standard operating procedures for the agentic workflow, where how does the agent should operate and do connect with our insurance systems internally and externally.

Last but not the least is that, yes, we have our own web portals, desktop applications, our mainframe systems, back-end systems, and legacy systems. They should be able to communicate them seamlessly without any heavy development and heavy investment need to be done onto that product. Those were some of the criteria where we evaluated the product with our workflows and the sample data.

AI Interviewer 00:36:05

That's a very comprehensive breakdown of the decision factors. Seamless integration with your legacy systems, robust FNOL and intake automation, and the ability to communicate with your various internal and external systems without heavy development. Regarding the pricing structure, how is Pace priced for your organization? Is it seat-based, usage-based, or something else?

Expert 00:36:30

As a part of the pricing structure, if I repeat back to, so definitely, it is the per seat-based. Since we are operating in a model two, that the workflows which are being used by our system, so if we are having their documentation and submission-based endorsement-related workflow being used too. We need to pay them by the annual platform fee of implementation and integration too. We have other model of usage and workflow fee.

For example, if the QA review has to be done automatically, that once the claim is ready to be sent to the insurance carrier for the adjudication and for specifically the process to be paid. Per year platform fee and then per dollar being processed onto the FNOLs notification process, and the QA being done. It's per seat platform usage per year for the platform fee, and then per year, the dollars being spent onto the per FNOL, and the QA being done operationally onto the P&C carrier side submissions.

AI Interviewer 00:37:33

Got it. It's a hybrid model, an annual platform fee plus usage-based pricing tied to the volume of FNOLs processed and QA reviews completed. That makes sense given the workflow-driven nature of the product. What did Pace replace when you brought it on? Was it a specific tool or purely manual processes?

Expert 00:37:56

Yes. Definitely, we were having our internal document writer and the policy management governance tool, which was being used. They have replaced that because now all of our, at least the facilities who are being processed with Pace onto the specifically onto the P&C side. The claims ingestion, the data ingestion, the ACORD document extraction, all is being done through the Pace. Our internal tool, which was previously doing such part as a manual extraction and manual readability has been replaced with.

Second important part, as you rightly said, the manual processes, which were either the review part or the underwriting part or the associating part of the claims to the policies, that has definitely been significantly. I'll not say reduced but we have replaced those teams with some other meaningful work onto the healthcare side, and now those areas of work is being handled through the Pace AI agentic workflows.

AI Interviewer 00:38:56

That's a clear picture. Pace replaced both an internal document management tool and a significant amount of manual processing while freeing up your team to focus on higher value healthcare work. Let me move on to implementation. How did the implementation process go, and were you directly involved in it?

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Expert 00:39:14
Yes, definitely. As a part of that, as we moved from the pilot part of the implementation to the full implementation of our facility integrations tool. That's where we have started bringing in the agentic process outsourcing works to the execution complex back-end automation part too, where I'll say that how we started with, as I was mentioning, we have created the human SOP manuals that if the policies, rules, and the conditions from the rule A, condition A need to be translated to condition B, condition C, kind of the scenario. We have documented that. That gets translated to the agentic operating procedures. Our manual SOP needs to be translated to the agentic procedure modules. Primarily, the biggest change is that, yes, we have defined how does the intake policies and the documentation.

It can be in the form, as I was mentioning, the PDF compliance, the emails coming in from our TPAs or MGAs, and the various standard ACORD forms, as I was mentioning, like ACORD five, ACORD 125. The most important part is the API integration. We have two-way communication tool. We need to have our internal communication, which we call it as the claim origination system tool, which is internal systems to us. The APIs need to have a reasoning calculation and the rules being applied to where it need to communicate with us internally and then need to go back to external systems. May it be hypothetically, as an example, will need to go back to any of the TPA system or to the external system like Duck Creek or Guidewire to fetch the latest information to how the obligations are being met.

The last part is the agentic action tool. We have given the specific actions, in this case, if the policy needs to be extracted, just give us the document ID and reference to the policy. That could be one of the action. Other action could be that, give us the filled-in ACORD 125 form if it needs to be worker compensation. Those actions need to be defined.

Comes the human loop of translating that into the contextual systems integration part where once the type out fields, the clicking of the buttons, the update of the record is happening, then whether a follow-up email need to be sent, a text message need to be sent, or a phone call needs to be initiated, or a human-in-the-loop need to be called out. What does it need to happen will be the next callout once the agent completes its action onto the intake part, translation part, and then to the action part. That's how we have integrated into our ecosystem model.

AI Interviewer 00:42:01
That's a really thorough walkthrough of the implementation. From translating human SOPs into agentic operating procedures, to the two-way API integrations with systems like Duck Creek and Guidewire, to defining the specific agentic actions and human-in-the-loop triggers. How long did that full implementation process take from start to go live?

Expert 00:42:23
Yes. As we started with the manual readability of the documentations and the setup tool, the initial agents and the workflows definitely took us between six weeks to eight weeks, and close to even some of the complex areas to the location-based facilities and the policies which are governing those facilities up to 10 weeks also. Initial agents took that close to, I can say, eight weeks to 10 weeks. For the other workflows and other areas to be worked upon, it took close to six weeks to maximum seven or eight weeks.

AI Interviewer 00:42:58
Roughly six to 10 weeks, depending on the complexity of the workflow. That's a pretty reasonable implementation timeline for something this integrated. Were any third-party resources required, or was it primarily handled internally between your team and Pace?

Expert 00:43:14
Yes. Initially, we were having some of our technology teams who were having internal consulting division and the consulting groups involved. We definitely haven't involved any third-party organizations or the technology partners. It was our internal technology group whom we have integrated to set up some of the integration channels, the omni-channel communications, for example, the web portals integration, login credentials, information integration part is being managed. We were definitely having the Pace platforms, the Tempo platforms of the Pace we were directly started working with through the facilities which we were onboarding and the P&C plan which we were able to be on board. That's how we were managing.

AI Interviewer 00:43:58
Got it. It's primarily your internal technology group working directly with Pace's team, no third-party integrators needed. That's a relatively lean implementation. Moving on to service quality, how would you characterize the quality of service and support you've received from Pace?

Expert 00:44:16
Definitely. As a part of the service quality, **I can say that the initial challenges** as a part of, how we were able to reliably have the reliability onto the teams which we were working with, the knowledge they were giving as a part of the assurance, specifically the physical evidence of the services they started delivering us, the dashboards they have given us, the aspect to. Most important, they were empathetic and

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responsive to our requests. I'll definitely say that initially, **we were having challenges** to how reliably we can share the information, how assurance-wise and the tangible delivery we are getting from them.

Yes, as a part of that, once we have started onboarding few of our workflows into these models with the Pace, definitely, I believe that **the service quality and the automated way of the agentic operations have been significantly improved**. That's how I believe that from the responsiveness to the velocity which we have picked from the assurance competence, they have shown us, the empathetic way of involving with us has been progressed while we were in the process of onboarding this process.

AI Interviewer 00:45:23

That's a great summary of the journey, starting with some questions around reliability and assurance, but ultimately finding Pace to be responsive, empathetic, and competent as you onboarded more workflows. What could Pace do to further increase your satisfaction with their service?

Expert 00:45:41

Yes. As I definitely said that, as a part of the overall experience or the more, I can say, collaboratively we can able to read our readability of the claims documentation, pulling up the full policies which are required to be as a coverage information, then populating, the most important, identifying the missing information, summarizing the case for us, and then keeping the human-in-the-loop, calling it out, where does the claims need to be breaked up or the information need to be breaked up, where does the P&C starts and where does the P&C ends, where does the healthcare-related information need to be pulled up.

Definitely supporting us during the underwriting and evaluating the risk of the policies which we are onboarding for the facilities. If those areas, I can say more extensively, we can collaborate with Pace, and Pace is able to give us some more accurate and more efficient models is where we believe that we will be able to get much more easier and much more flawless implementations of the Pace.

AI Interviewer 00:46:42

It sounds like enhancing the collaborative aspects, particularly around claims documentation, identifying missing information, and supporting underwriting and risk evaluation would really boost your satisfaction. Have you renewed your agreement with Pace? If so, what were the key decision factors in that renewal?

Expert 00:47:03

Yes, since post and one full year cycle will be closely ended in July, mid-August. It will be completing, so we are in the process of definitely reviewing those areas of where **we have operationally impacted our BPO headcount**, our operational processes, our document processing has been significantly improved. **Our policy servicing for the P&C-related claims have been significantly made efficient**. **Our submission process accuracy has been improved too**. Definitely, considering these areas where we have got even the underwriting support and then the documentation part of the submissions and QA. Considering holistically, where we were standing a year back and with an outcome-based agentic processes where we stand as of now, I believe that that's where the real mix of the decision points will be there.

AI Interviewer 00:47:54

Got it. You're approaching the renewal decision point now, and the key factors will be the measurable operational improvements you've seen, headcount impact, document processing efficiency, submission accuracy, and underwriting support. Has your spend with Pace changed since you first started? Do you expect it to change over the next two to three years?

Expert 00:48:21

Yes. As I started with, so we started with the $50,000-$100,000 spend, and now it should stand between $100,000-$250,000. Yes, over a period of time, if the contract gets renewed and we are onboarding more practices and more P&C-related workflows, definitely we are expecting that the spend would be increasing over the next two to three years.

AI Interviewer 00:48:49

I appreciate your detailed insights so far. Just a few more questions to wrap up. What would it take for you to switch to a competing product or alternate solution?

Expert 00:49:02

Definitely. As I mentioned, if there is more accuracy, more operationally support to the workflows of document readability, full claim document readability, managing the end-to-end policy life cycles, the checks which need to be made where the identifying the information need to be managed, and then the segregation of the callouts for the P&C claims versus healthcare claims, and then flagging any unusual

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circumstances through the modeling part and calling it the human-in-the-loop workflow at that point in time will be. Definitely, if any other product offers those areas better than the Pace, maybe it will be the time for us to move from the Pace.

AI Interviewer 00:49:40

That makes sense. Accuracy, end-to-end policy life cycle management, better claim segregation, and smarter human-in-the-loop flagging would be the key triggers. How hard would it actually be for your organization to switch away from Pace at this point?

Expert 00:49:56

Definitely, we are in the transition of bringing in more and more workflows of the multiple workflows into the Pace, including our workers' compensation, the facilities insurance, the life, the floor management, the floor staff lives into onboarding onto this. We are in the process of implementation, configuring, and deployment-related information too. As and when we are moving the data between our organization to the external systems, we definitely are ensuring that it is PHI and PII-compliant. Tomorrow, if we need to move on, the other platform, if it is PHI and HIPAA-compliant network, GDPR-compliant network, **it will not be much difficult** for us to move a compliant data from one location to another location.

AI Interviewer 00:50:45

The data portability is relatively manageable given your compliance standards, but the real switching cost would be in reconfiguring all those workflows, SOPs, and agentic operating procedures you've built up in Pace. What price increase, in percentage terms, would lead you to seriously consider looking for an alternative solution?

Expert 00:51:08

Definitely. As I said, it's right now the hybrid fees, platform fee, plus the FNOL submissions and the review QA part fees, which is being paid too. If the platform fee is, I can say at very high level, if it is more than 10% increase, and then if **it is the integration fee and the compliance fee per FNOL submission and review is even increased even 5%, because ours are like, the volumes are high**. Maybe **the margins and the ROI per claim is less** if it is even 5% increase. 10% platform fee, 5% per transaction fee is increased, **that is definitely a huge impact to us**.

AI Interviewer 00:51:52

That's a really clear threshold. 10% on the platform fee and 5% on the transaction fees would be the point where you'd start seriously evaluating alternatives. On a scale of 1-10, how would you score your NPS for Pace?

Expert 00:52:09

As of now, as I mentioned, so we started with a greenfield implementation for where we were having our internal platforms, internal products managing, then the human teams who are managing the end-to-end workflows too. Pace has automated many parts into one agentic-based completeness area too. Definitely, I will give it between eight to nine scale is what I'll give the NPS for.

AI Interviewer 00:52:34

That's a strong score. What are the top three reasons you'd put it at an eight to nine?

Expert 00:52:41

Definitely. As a part of the process, I can say that, yes, reading in our inbound data, then classifying them into the different submissions, handling our FNOL intake, reviewing that, calling in some of the areas for our human-in-the-loop, and the analytics part, giving us the knowledge as a part of the analytics too, has been primarily we have learned along with Pace as a product, the workflows, is the reason where at least I am being one of the user of the product is giving them that rating.

AI Interviewer 00:53:11

Those are strong reasons. The inbound data classification, FNOL intake automation, human-in-the-loop integration, and the analytics capabilities all contributing to that score. What would Pace need to do to get you from an eight or nine to a 10?

Expert 00:53:28

Definitely. As I said, they should be able to identify the claims appropriately, classify the documents, should be able to identify the policies and the shortcomings of that, any kind of the supporting document which is being missed for. The most important part is calling in the

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human-in-the-loop area for the service is what I can say if **they can improve, is definitely will be a significant improve in the NPS**. Once again, we are, I believe, over an hour. If you would like to just conclude the conversation.

AI Interviewer 00:54:01

Absolutely. I appreciate your patience. Just two final questions and we'll wrap up. Are you excited about your future with Pace as a product?

Expert 00:54:13

Yes, definitely. I'll definitely write from the journey of import, extractions, rule-based readability, the decisions it is allowing us to make, the human approvals it is seeking, and the response it is giving back us is definitely making us a satisfied customer of the workflow.

AI Interviewer 00:54:29

That's great to hear. Finally, is there anything else you think should have been asked or covered in today's conversation?

Expert 00:54:37

I believe we have covered the product end-to-end, the product implementation, and the aspect very well. Definitely, I would for sure will say that there are other products and other areas which definitely as a part of the area of the P&C business, the other products and the other areas which are parallelly doing well as well. If those competitive, **I can say, advantages, disadvantages,** and where the competitors are breaking through in the next part of the automation, we can definitely look upon those areas as well. We could have looked upon those areas as well.

AI Interviewer 00:55:12

Thanks for your insights today. Have a great rest of your day. Goodbye.

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